5. A central data catalog makes sure data products can be stored anywhere and still be accessible and findable.

8.3.6 Databricks architecture summary

The architecture described in this section is focused on using the data-transformation powers of Databricks to the maximum. It is thus intertwined with the Databricks platform. We also saw that we need a bit of help in getting data into the central Delta Lake to unleash the Databricks' powers.

The one big strength of this setup is the minimal maintenance effort with great support for all the analytical workloads companies usually want to take on. On the flip side, we see limited support for development teams and the lock-in effect into the Databricks platform. Take a look at the summary profile in table 8.3.

Table 8.3 Databricks architecture profile

Short description	Platform is technologically very centralized but needs a bit of support on the ingestion part. Technologically, getting data into the data product isn't owned by the data producers.
Pros	Runs as a service. Extremely low maintenance effort. Great support for data engineering, data science, and analysts' workflows.
Cons	Lock-in effect into Databricks. No native support for development teams.
Suitable situations	Small- to medium-sized companies focused on building analytical data products fast, whether they're ML systems or reports and dashboards.

Finally, we will take a look at a setup utilizing the whole Kafka ecosystem. Whereas the focus on this setup is more on data engineers and scientists, the next setup is more geared to including software engineers as well. In